

overflow:auto creates a mock <iframe> without all the accessibility headaches of <iframe>s). For this job, all pages needed to be the same height all the way across, regardless of how much content was used.

Visible - The content is not clipped. It renders outside the element.

Hidden - The scrollbar is not displayed to see the rest of the content.

scroll - The scrollbar is displayed even if there is nothing to scroll.

auto - The scrollbar is displayed depending on the content

This was achieved by using a container with overflow:auto applied and a set height, ensuring that no matter how much information appears in the container, the total height of the page does not increase. Let's look at creating our own example—a simple news stream using CSS.

All that is needed is a simple container. Here, it is given a class of stream to denote that it carries all the streamed news items.

```
<div class="stream">
<p>All the stuff you want to scroll goes in here.</p>
</div>
```

Note that for this example, you will need to paste plenty of content into this container to see the effect of the overflow.. With that taken care of, we can move on to the nifty styling. Now define the stream selector. First, the size of the box is declared (here it is a square 300×300 pixels), and some padding is declared to ensure the content does not touch the border. Most importantly, the overflow property is given the auto value.

```
.stream {
width:300px;
height:300px;
padding:10px;
border:1px solid #999;
background-color:#FFF;
overflow:auto;
}
```

By giving the box a set height, you ensure that it does not expand or contract based on the content it holds. If there is more content than the box can hold, the scrollbar will automatically appear, allowing you to scroll through the whole text.

The possibilities here are endless, but be wary of using multiple overflow boxes on your pages. A web page that features umpteen scrollbars can confuse users though.